Early Reading Screen: instructions

What it is. A one-to-one reading screen for children joining **Years 1 to 3**, and for an **older student who is new to English**. It shows where the child's **decoding** is (letter sounds, phonics, tricky words) and the **book band** they can read with understanding. It takes **about 10 to 12 minutes** at most; the start points keep it shorter for most children. All of it is in English: finding the child's level of English reading is one of its main purposes. The year group assessor instructions say where to start; the results go on the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`) and the final mark sheet.

What to print

- **Reading cards** (`Early_Reading_Screen_Cards`): once, in plastic sleeves. The child reads from these.
- **Instructions** (this guide, `Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`): once, for the assessor's folder.
- **Record sheets** (`Early_Reading_Screen_Record`, Sheets 1 to 13): one set for each child. You only need the running record sheets for the passages you use.

1. At a glance

Part	Cards	What the child does	About	Score
1 Letter sounds	1, 2	Says the sound of 26 single letters, then 18 letter groups (sh, ai, igh ...).	2 min	/ 26 and / 18
2 Phonics words	3 (practice), 4 to 7	Reads 40 words. **Section 1** (words 1 to 20): single letters, consonant digraphs, adjacent consonants (CVC, CCVC, CVCC). **Section 2** (words 21 to 40): vowel digraphs and trigraphs, split digraphs, two-syllable words. In each section 10 are real words and 10 are creature names (nonsense words).	3 min	/ 20 and / 20
3 Tricky words	8	Reads 20 common exception words: 10 from the Year 1 list and 10 from the Year 2 list.	1 min	/ 20
4 Passages	9 to 16	Reads two or three short stories aloud while you take a running record, then answers 3 or 4 questions on each.	4 to 6 min	book band
Total		Not every child does every part (Section 2).	**10 to 12 min**	

You need: the reading cards; one set of record sheets; a pencil; a watch; a plain card to cover lines if the child finds a full card too busy; a levelled book from the school's assessment set (optional, see 5.5).

2. Start points, stopping rules and timing

Where to start

Child	Start with	Then
Year 1 (age 5)	Letter sounds: Card 1, then Card 2 if 15 or more of Card 1 are right.	Section 1 (practice Card 3, then Cards 4 and 5). Section 2 (Cards 6 and 7) only if Section 1 is 15 or more. Tricky words (Card 8). Passages: see "Which passage first".
Year 2 (age 6)	Section 1, words 1 to 10 (practice Card 3, then Card 4).	**If words 1 to 10 are easy** (9 or 10 right, most read without sounding out): skip the letter sounds. Do words 11 to 20, then Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more, then the tricky words and passages. **If not:** finish Section 1 (and Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more), then do the letter sounds, the tricky words and the passages.
Year 3 (age 7)	Section 1, words 1 to 10.	**If easy:** go straight to Section 2 (skip words 11 to 20 and the letter sounds). Section 2 is 15 or more: go on to the passages. Section 2 is 12 to 14: tricky words, then passages. Section 2 is under 12: go back to words 11 to 20, then tricky words and passages. **If not easy:** as Year 2.
Older student new to English (age 8 or more)	Letter sounds (Cards 1 and 2) and Section 1.	Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more. Tricky words. Passages if Section 1 is 8 or more. Their reading band comes from their year group's reading paper; this screen shows where their decoding is, for planning.

Words skipped by a start rule are not scored: write "start rule" across them, and record the section as, for example, "10 / 10 on words 1 to 10, start rule".

Which passage first

Phonics result	First passage
Section 1 under 8	None. The book band is "not yet Pink". Stop after the tricky words.
Section 1 8 to 15	Passage 1, Pink (Card 9)
Section 1 16 or more, and Section 2 under 8 or not given	Passage 2, Red (Card 10)
Section 2 8 to 13	Passage 3, Yellow (Card 11)
Section 2 14 to 17	Passage 4, Light Blue (Card 12)
Section 2 18 or more	Passage 5, Green (Card 13). Year 3 and older: Passage 6, Orange (Card 14).

Moving between passages

- **A pass** is 90% accuracy or more **and** at least half the questions right (2 of 3, or 2 of 4).
- After a pass, give the next passage up. Stop at the first passage that is not a pass.
- If the first passage is not a pass, go down one passage (not below Passage 1).
- Use two or three passages. Give a fourth only if the child is keen and there is time.
- **The child's book band level is the highest passage passed.** Also note the highest passage read at 90% or more, if it is higher (decoding ahead of understanding, 6.3).

Stopping rules

Part	Stop when
Letter sounds	6 wrong in a row. Then say: "Look at the rest. Point to any you know." Mark the ones the child points to and says correctly.
Phonics words	5 wrong in a row in a section. The rest of that section scores 0.
Tricky words	5 wrong in a row.
A passage	The child goes past the "too hard" number of errors before the end, or is stuck on most lines. Say: "Thank you. You worked hard on that one." It is not a pass.
The whole screen	About 12 minutes, or the child is tired, upset or asks to stop. Record it on the summary sheet.

Timing

- Letter sounds about 2 minutes, phonics words about 3, tricky words about 1, passages and questions about 4 to 6.
- Write the start and finish times on the summary sheet (Sheet 13). Do not time the reading for a score; note it only if it is very slow.
- If the child is tiring, finish the passage you are on and stop. A short break and a return later is fine; record it.

3. Before you start

Setting up

- A quiet room. Sit side by side at a table. The card the child needs is in front of them; the record sheets are on a clipboard, out of the child's sight.
- Give this screen after the picture talk and listening (see the order of the day in the year group booklet). By then you have heard the child's spoken English, which helps you judge accent (4.4).
- Turn the cards yourself. Point to each item as the child reads it, or let the child point.

Access rules for this screen (the same in every year group)

- Say only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, sound out, or read the cards or passages aloud.
- The child may ask for an instruction to be repeated in English. Repeat it as written.
- Everything is in English: letters, words and passages are read in English, and the answers to the questions about a passage must be in English. An answer in Chinese scores 0.
- Praise effort, never answers: "Thank you." "You are working hard." Do not say "good", "right" or "no" after a word.
- The child may stop a part when they have done what they can. Never push a distressed child: take a break or stop, and record it.
- Extra time or other arrangements for a known need: record them on the summary sheet.

Say at the start: "Now we are going to do some reading. Some of it is easy and some of it is hard. That is fine. Just do your best."

4. Marking conventions for learners of English

4.1 The main rule

> **Mark the reading, not the accent.** A word is right when a listener who can see the text would know which word the child said. Many children joining from Chinese schools speak English with features of Mandarin pronunciation. These are part of their spoken English, not reading errors, unless they change the word.

4.2 These are errors (each one counts 1)

Error	What the child does	Example	Mark
S Substitution	Says a different word, or a word that is not real.	"big" read as "bag"; "went" read as "want"; "strong" read as "string"	Write what the child said above the word.
O Omission	Leaves out a word, or leaves off an ending that is written (-s or -ed). This counts even if the child leaves endings off when they speak, as in the Graded Sentence Reading Screen; note the pattern.	"a big green kite" read as "a green kite"; "kicked" read as "kick"	Circle the word or ending.
I Insertion	Adds a word that is not there.	"on the mat" read as "on the big mat"	Write ^ and the added word.
T Told	Is stuck. You wait about 5 seconds, then say the word.		Write T above the word.

An error counts each time it happens, except a **name**: count a name error once in each passage, however often it comes.

4.3 These are not errors

Not an error	Example	Mark
SC Self-correction: the child reads a word wrongly, then puts it right.	"bag … big"	Write what was said, then SC.
R Repetition of a word or phrase.	"the cat … the cat is on the mat"	Underline the repeated words, write R.
Sounding out, then the right word.	"s-t-u-ck, stuck"	Nothing.
Pausing, reading slowly.		Nothing: it shows in the fluency rating.
l and r	"led" for red, "lain" for rain	acc
n and l	"nong" for long	acc
v and w	"wan" for van	acc
th said as s, f, d or z	"sank you" for thank you, "fink" for think, "dis" for this	acc
A dropped, quiet or unreleased final consonant sound, when the rest of the word is right (not a written ending such as -s or -ed: see Omission)	"be(d)", "do(g)", "stam(p)"	acc
A small vowel added after a final consonant	"bed-uh", "dog-uh", "kite-uh"	acc
The -ed ending said in full	"kick-ed" for kicked	acc
A short vowel said a little long or tense, when it is still clearly that vowel and the child gave the English sound on Card 1	"sit" a little like "seet"	acc
A name read in a Chinese or English way	Hao, Jun, Shanghai, Liu	Nothing.
A whole line missed (the child lost their place)		Point to the line: "Try this line." Mark the words as usual. The skip is not an error.

4.4 When you are not sure

Ask yourself two questions:

1. Would a listener who can see the text know which word the child said?
2. Does the child say this sound the same way when they talk (in the picture talk, for example)?

Two yeses: it is accent. Count it right and write **acc**. Otherwise count it as an error and write down what you heard. If you are still not sure, give the benefit of the doubt and make a note: patterns across many words are more useful than any one word.

4.5 Pinyin letter values (P)

A child who learnt pinyin may give an English letter its pinyin value. This is not guessing: the child is using a letter-sound system they know well. **Write P** above the letter or word, and what you heard.

Letters	English sound	Pinyin value the child may give	Example
i	short i, as in "sit"	"ee"	"sit" read as "seat"
u	short u, as in "up"	"oo"	"mub" read as "moob"
e	short e, as in "leg"	the pinyin e, like the vowel in "her"	"leg" read as "lerg"
o	short o, as in "on"	"aw" or "wo"	"dop" read as "dwop"
ai	as in "rain"	"eye"	"rain" read as "rine"
c	"k"	"ts"	"cake" read as "tsake"
x	"ks"	a soft "sh"	"x" said as "sh"; "six" read as "sish"
q, qu	"kw"	a soft "ch"	"qu" said as "chu"
z	"z"	"dz" or "ts"	"z" said as "dz"
j, r, h	as in "jam", "red", "hat"	close to the pinyin values	Accept: not P.
b, d, g, m and the other consonants	the sound alone	the sound with a vowel after it: "bo", "de", "ge" (from learning pinyin)	Accept: not P.

How P is scored

- **Letter sounds, phonics words and tricky words:** P scores 0, because the child did not give the English sound. Count the Ps separately: they show a working sound system that needs the English values (6.5).
- **Passages:** use the main rule. If the word is still clear in the sentence ("six eggs" read as "sish eggs"), it is not an error: write P only. If the word is not clear, it is an error: write P and what you heard.

4.6 Marks to use

Mark	Meaning	Counts as an error?
nothing, or a tick	read correctly	no
the word the child said, written above (S)	substitution	yes
circle (O)	omission	yes
^ and the word (I)	insertion	yes
T	told by you after about 5 seconds	yes
A	appeal: the child asked for help, and you said "Try it."	no, unless it ends in T
SC	self-correction	no
R	repetition	no
acc	accent feature; the word is clear	no
P	pinyin letter value	letters, phonics words, tricky words: yes. Passages: only if the word is not clear
N	letter name instead of the sound (letter sounds only)	yes
SO	sounds only: the child said the sounds but did not blend them (phonics words)	yes
RW	a creature word read as a real word ("blom" read as "bloom")	yes

5. Scripts and scoring

5.1 Letter sounds (Cards 1 and 2)

Card 1. Say: "Look at these letters. Tell me the sound each letter makes." Point to the first letter. "What sound does this one make?"

- Point to each letter in turn, along each row.
- **If the child says the letter name** (the first time only): "Yes, that is its name. What sound does it make?" After that, mark N for a name and move on.
- **If the child does not know** after about 5 seconds: "That is fine. Next one."
- **Stop** after 6 wrong in a row. Say: "Look at the rest. Point to any you know."

Card 2 (only if 15 or more right on Card 1). **Say:** "These letters go together. They make one sound. Tell me the sound." Point to each in turn.

Accept	Do not accept
The common English sound: a as in "ant", e as in "egg", i as in "ink", o as in "on", u as in "up"; c and k as "k"; g as in "go"; q as "kw" (or "k"); x as "ks"; y as in "yes". A consonant sound with a small vowel after it ("buh", "bo"). Accent features (4.3), such as v said close to w.	A letter name (N). A pinyin value (P). The sound of a different letter. A long vowel for a single vowel letter ("ay" for a): that is the name, mark N.
Card 2: sh as in "ship"; ch as in "chin"; th as in "thin" or "this" (a single s, f or d sound is accent: accept); ng as in "ring"; ck "k"; qu "kw"; ai as in "rain"; ee as in "see"; igh as in "night"; oa as in "boat"; oo as in "moon" or "book"; ar as in "car"; or as in "for"; ur as in "fur"; ow as in "cow" or "snow"; oi as in "coin"; ear as in "near"; air as in "fair".	Two separate sounds ("s-h", "o-a"). Letter names ("s, h"). A pinyin value ("ai" as "eye", mark P).

5.2 Phonics words (Cards 3 to 7)

Card 3 (practice). Point to **hat**. **Say:** "Now we are going to read some words. This is a real word. Can you read it?" If the child cannot, say: "It says hat."

Point to the big creature, then to **jop**. **Say:** "Look. This is a creature. This word has a creature next to it, so it is the creature's name. It says jop. Creature names are not real words."

Say: "Some words are real words. Some words are creature names. Read them the best you can."

Card 4. Say: "Now read these words to me. Start here." Point to word 1, then to each word in turn along each row (the grey numbers match the record sheet). Turn to Card 5 after word 10.

Card 6 (Section 2). **Say:** "Here are some more words. Some are real words and some are creature names. Read them the best you can."

- If the child says nothing for about 5 seconds: "That is fine. Next one." Do not tell the word.
- The child may sound out. Score the word they blend in the end. Write what the child said for every word that scores 0.

Scoring: 1 for each word read correctly. Accent features score 1 (4.3). Pinyin values (P), sounds only (SO) and creature words read as real words (RW) score 0. A real word must be read as that word. A creature word scores 1 for any reading that fits its letters, including these:

Creature word	Accept
thep	th as in "thin" or as in "this"
chulp	"ch" as in "chin"
jeek	rhymes with "seek"
toap	rhymes with "soap"
darp, sorp	with or without an r sound at the end of the vowel
choil	rhymes with "boil"
jeme	"jeem"
plome	rhymes with "home"
flape	rhymes with "tape"
lompid	"lom-pid", stress on either part
shoomit	"shoo-mit"; oo as in "moon" or as in "book"

5.3 Tricky words (Card 8)

Say: "These are words you might know. Read them to me." Point to each word in turn.

- If the child does not know after about 5 seconds: "That is fine. Next one."
- 1 for each word read correctly within about 5 seconds. Sounding out that ends with the right word is fine. A word sounded out as it is spelt ("was" read to rhyme with "has") scores 0.
- Stop after 5 wrong in a row.
- Words 1 to 10 are from the Year 1 list of common exception words and words 11 to 20 from the Year 2 list (English National Curriculum, spelling appendix).

5.4 Passages (Cards 9 to 16)

Each passage is matched to a book band and an Oxford Level (the levels used for Oxford Reading Tree books), so a real levelled book at the same level can be used in its place (5.5).

Passage	Card	Title	Book band	Oxford Level	Words	Independent: errors at most	Pass (90%): errors at most	Pass: questions at least
1	9	Where Is the Cat?	Pink	1+	23	1	2	2 of 3
2	10	At the Market	Red	2	36	1	3	2 of 3
3	11	The Kite	Yellow	3	57	2	5	2 of 4
4	12	A New Friend	Light Blue	4	79	3	7	2 of 4
5	13	The Lucky Dumpling	Green	5	99	4	9	2 of 4
6	14	The Fast Train	Orange	6	126	6	12	2 of 4
7	15	The Rabbit Lantern	Turquoise and Purple	7 to 8	151	7	15	2 of 4
8	16	The Drummer	Gold and White	9 to 10	178	8	17	2 of 4

1. Choose the first passage from Section 2. Put its card in front of the child.
2. **Say** the introduction printed on the passage's record sheet: the title and one sentence about the story. This is the only text you read aloud. The title does not count in the word count.
3. While the child reads, mark the running record (4.6). You do not need to tick every word: mark only what is different.
4. If the child stops or asks for help, say: "Try it." If the child is still stuck after about 5 seconds, say the word and mark T.
5. When the child finishes, **say:** "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story." Ask each question as written. You may repeat a question once. If an answer is too short to judge, you may say once: "Tell me more."
6. Score the accuracy, self-corrections, fluency and questions on the sheet. Decide whether it is a pass and move up or down (Section 2).

Accuracy = (words minus errors) ÷ words × 100. Each sheet has the table already worked out.

Accuracy	Level	What it means
95% or more	Independent (Ind)	The child can read books at this band on their own.
90 to 94%	Instructional (Ins)	The right level for teaching, with support.
Below 90%	Too hard	Not a pass, whatever the questions show.

Self-correction rate = (errors + self-corrections) ÷ self-corrections, written as 1 : the answer. For example, 6 errors and 2 SC: 8 ÷ 2 = 4, so 1 : 4. A rate of 1 : 3 or better (1 : 1, 1 : 2, 1 : 3) shows a child who checks their reading. No SC: write "none".

Fluency (rate the whole passage)

Rating		What it sounds like
1	Word by word	One word at a time, with long pauses. No sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Some phrasing	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word by word. Little attention to punctuation. Little expression.
3	Mostly phrased	Reads in sensible phrases and mostly follows full stops and commas. Some pauses to work out harder words.
4	Fluent and expressive	Smooth and close to natural speech. Follows punctuation. The voice changes for questions and for what characters say.

Questions: 1 mark each. The child may look back at the story. Accept answers in the child's own words, one word, or a short phrase; grammar mistakes do not matter. Pointing counts only where the question asks the child to show. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Book band level = the highest passage read at **90% or more** with **at least half the questions** right.

5.5 Using a real levelled book instead

- You may use a real levelled book at the same band instead of a passage, for example an Oxford Reading Tree book from the school's assessment set. The book list is in `01_Reading_Books_and_Materials.md`.
- Choose a book the child has not read. Ask: "Have you read this book before?"
- Use the same method: introduce it with the title and one sentence, then use the same marks, error rules, accuracy levels, self-correction rate and fluency scale.
- Pink to Yellow: use the whole book. Light Blue and above: use a section of about 100 to 150 words, and count the words before you start.
- Use **Sheet 12**. Before you start, write 3 or 4 questions (literal, inference, vocabulary, and prediction or personal response) and the answers you expect. A pass is the same: 90% or more and at least half the questions.
- Write the book's title, band and Oxford Level on the summary sheet.

6. What the results mean

6.1 Is decoding secure?

Result	What it suggests
Card 1: 24 or more / 26; Card 2: 15 or more / 18	Letter-sound knowledge is secure.
Card 1: 10 to 23	Partly secure. List the letters missed: they show what to teach first.
Section 1: 16 or more / 20	Blending is secure with single letters, consonant digraphs and adjacent consonants.
Section 1: under 12	Blending is not yet secure. The child needs phonics teaching from the early stages.
Section 2: 14 or more / 20	Vowel digraphs and split digraphs are mostly secure.
Section 1 secure, Section 2 under 10	Single letters and blends are secure; vowel digraphs and split digraphs are not yet. Typical of a fluent English reader partway through Reception.
Both sections secure	Decoding is secure for Key Stage 1 phonics. The next limit is vocabulary and understanding: look at the passages.
Tricky words: 8 or more of the Year 1 words (or of the Year 2 words)	The common exception words for that year are known by sight.

6.2 Real words and nonsense words

- **Real words much higher than nonsense words** (3 or more higher in a section): the child may be reading known words by sight, or guessing from the first letter. Decoding of new words is weaker than it looks. Check the passages for guesses that fit the picture or the meaning but not the letters.

- **Nonsense words about the same as, or higher than, real words:** decoding is working. Low real-word scores then often mean the child does not know these English words, so they cannot check them against meaning: a vocabulary gap, not a phonics gap.
- **Many RW** (creature words turned into real words): the child expects reading to make sense, which is good, but does not yet trust their decoding.
- **Many SO** (sounds only): the child knows the sounds but cannot yet blend them. Teach blending.

6.3 Decoding and understanding

Pattern	What it suggests	What to record
Accuracy 95% or more, but fewer than half the questions right	**Decoding ahead of understanding.** The child can say the words but does not yet understand enough English. Common in children taught phonics in after-school classes.	The book band level is the level with understanding. Also record "decodes at" the highest passage read at 90% or more. The need is vocabulary and spoken English.
Accuracy below 90%, but most questions right	**Understanding ahead of decoding.** Spoken English and meaning are strong; decoding is behind. Often a child from a bilingual school taught whole words, or a confident speaker who uses the pictures and the meaning.	The book band level is lower than the child's understanding. The need is systematic phonics; progress is often quick.
Low accuracy and few questions right	The passage is too hard.	The level below is the book band level.

6.4 Vocabulary gaps

- The child reads a word correctly but cannot say what it means (a vocabulary question wrong).
- Substitutions that look like the word but do not make sense ("strong" read as "string", "shiny" read as "shy").
- Note the words the child did not know. They show what to teach, and they are evidence for the reading band.

6.5 Patterns typical for children who learnt pinyin

- **Strong blending of short words:** pinyin is spelt sound by sound, so blending transfers well.
- **Pinyin vowel values:** i as "ee", u as "oo", e as the pinyin e, ai as "eye" ("rain" read as "rine").
- **Pinyin consonant values:** c as "ts", q as "ch", x as "sh", z as "dz".
- **A vowel added to consonant sounds** ("bo", "de"), from the way pinyin is taught. Not an error.
- **Letter names known, sounds not known** (many N marks): the child learnt the alphabet song but not phonics.
- **Split digraphs and silent letters are new:** pinyin has no silent letters, so "cake" may be read as "cak" or "ca-ke".
- **English vowel digraphs** (ee, oa, oo, igh) are new, and may be read as two sounds.
- **Final consonants dropped or softened:** Mandarin syllables end only in a vowel, n or ng. This is accent (4.3).
- These children already know that letters stand for sounds, so they usually respond well to direct teaching of the English values.

6.6 Book bands: what a fluent English reader usually reads

These are **Oxford's guide figures for fluent English readers** (Oxford levelling guidance: end of Reception Oxford Level 3, end of Year 1 Level 6, end of Year 2 Level 10, end of Year 3 Level 13). Oxford says the chart is a guide only, and schools vary. **Most children joining from Chinese schools will read below these bands at entry. That is expected**, and it is what the A to E band in 6.7 takes into account: the band describes how far the child's English reading has come, compared with these figures.

Point in the school year	Age (about)	Book band	Oxford Level	Phonics on this screen
Start of Year 1	5	Yellow	3	Letter sounds and Section 1 mostly secure; some of Section 2
Start of Year 2	6	Orange	6	Sections 1 and 2 mostly secure
Start of Year 3	7	White	10	Secure; tricky words known
Start of Year 4	8	Lime and above	11 and above	Secure. Beyond the top of this screen (Passage 8 is Gold and White).

Oxford Levels and book bands, for matching a real book: 1 Lilac, 1+ Pink, 2 Red, 3 Yellow, 4 Light Blue, 5 Green, 6 Orange, 7 Turquoise, 8 Purple, 9 Gold, 10 White, 11 Lime.

6.7 Band guide: the reading band A to E

Use the column for the year group the child is joining. "Passage" means the book band level: the highest passage passed (5.4). Band E means comparable to a fluent English reader of the same age, so it is set at the Oxford figures in 6.6.

Reading band	Age 5, joining Year 1 (fluent readers: about Yellow)	Age 6, joining Year 2 (fluent readers: about Orange)	Age 7, joining Year 3 (fluent readers: about White)
A New to English	Fewer than 10 letter sounds; reads no words.	Fewer than 10 letter sounds, or fewer than 4 Section 1 words.	Fewer than 8 Section 1 words; no passage.
B Early acquisition	10 or more letter sounds; reads 1 to 9 Section 1 words.	4 or more Section 1 words but no passage; or Passage 1 (Pink).	8 or more Section 1 words but no passage; or Passage 1, 2 or 3 (Pink, Red, Yellow).
C Developing competence	Section 1: 10 or more but no passage; or Passage 1 (Pink).	Passage 2 or 3 (Red, Yellow).	Passage 4 or 5 (Light Blue, Green).
D Competent	Passage 2 (Red).	Passage 4 or 5 (Light Blue, Green).	Passage 6 or 7 (Orange; Turquoise and Purple).
E Fluent	Passage 3 (Yellow) or above.	Passage 6 (Orange) or above.	Passage 8 (Gold and White).

- **E also needs reading that sounds fluent for the age:** fluency 3 or 4 and most of the questions right at that level. If not, give D.
- **Best fit, not a formula.** If the results are uneven (for example Passage 4 passed with very few letter sounds known), use judgement and say why in the notes. Check against the Graded Sentence Reading Screen and the listening and speaking bands.
- **Joining later in the school year:** expect a little more for D and E, about one passage higher by the second half of the year.
- **An older student new to English:** this screen only finds the floor. As a guide: below Pink, A; Pink to Yellow, B; Light Blue to Orange, C. If they pass Passage 7 or 8, their band comes from the year group's reading paper. Use the letter sound and phonics results to plan teaching.